



MONTHLY UPDATE

Mali: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01 • 25 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • TECHNOLOGY •
CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

A five-day digital week set the agenda and nothing was enacted. The [fourth Semaine du Numerique](#) produced a [recommendation set](#) covering a national artificial-intelligence strategy, a data-management law, a startups law, a national digital council, a regional protocol on artificial-intelligence governance and a law making the state operator the sole holder of national transport infrastructure – six instruments, all at the recommendation stage.

Against that agenda, the working parts are the data-protection authority and the courts. The authority [opened its second session of the year with more than 1,000 files](#) and [authorised the processing of demobilisation beneficiary data, with three days of training on it](#). In the other direction, a press-freedom body [reported cybercrime provisions being used to prosecute journalists](#), while the government [launched a disinformation awareness campaign targeting 60,000 people](#) and a civil-society body [launched a content-checking application](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

On 15 July, at the UEMOA digital economy salon in Ouagadougou, Mali [spoke for the three AES states and the salon adopted a Declaration de Ouagadougou](#) recommending that member governments place digital at the centre of national strategies, and identifying financing opportunities under the union's ICT fund. The [same communique records the minister at the Global Dialogue on AI Governance and the World Summit on the Information Society in Geneva from 6 to 10 July](#), arguing for Global South data rights, fairer sharing of the benefits of artificial intelligence, a capacity-building fund for least-developed countries, and the integration of African languages into AI models. Positions stated, with no instrument or commitment attached to any of them.

The same 1 August recommendations also included establishing a [Conseil national du Numerique](#).

Legislation and regulation

On 29 July the Garde des Sceaux [instructed all prosecutors, justices of the peace and judicial police to act against networks recruiting through WhatsApp, TikTok and Snapchat](#). The communique enumerates existing penal qualifications and adds that the staging, filming, publication and commentary of such images are themselves offences falling under cybercrime; no new statute was made, no platform was notified, and parents, educators, landlords and hotel keepers are called on to watch and denounce.

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique's recommendations included [a data-management law and a startups law](#).

Data protection

On 3 August the [data-protection authority opened its second 2026 session](#) with more than 1,000 files before it over ten days — authorisations, declarations, video-surveillance oversight, formal notices and direct sanction procedures — its president grounding the sanctions in Loi n2013-015 as amended.

Regional collaboration

On 24 July Mali was [re-elected to the African Telecommunications Union board for 2027-2031](#) at the Abuja plenipotentiary.

The same 1 August recommendations also included [a protocol between AES states to harmonise AI governance](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The same 3 August the cybercrime pole [sentenced Chahana Takiou to 12 months with six suspended](#) on a charge of undermining the credit of the state through the judicial institution, over remarks at a Bamako media forum in June 2026 arguing that journalists should be tried under press-offence law.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 15 July CSquared [added capacity on the 2Africa West subsea system](#) to the West African backbone whose inland fibre reaches Mali, giving an independent route behind the Abidjan, Accra and Lagos landings.

On 23 July Moov Africa Malitel [announced the retirement of ADSL and migration to FTTH by end-2026](#); no subscriber or coverage figure accompanied it.

On 27 July Maliweb carried a named-analyst investigation into the universal access fund which also [reports AFRIBONE as the sole surviving independent internet provider](#), buying wholesale IP transit at near-retail prices after incumbents allegedly pressed the backbone operator to stop selling dark fibre.

On 30 July the Semaine du Numerique's opening panel [set a universal connectivity target of 2030](#), with the roadmap to be drafted jointly with Burkina Faso and Niger. On 1 August the week's recommendations included [a law making SMTD-SA the sole national operator of transport, transmission, storage and broadcast infrastructure](#).

DPI

Data Exchange

The national public key infrastructure and electronic signature services were [recommended for effective deployment at the digital week on 1 August](#). Nothing names a first service, an operator or a date.

Customs is the one exchange with a build behind it. At a Bamako round table on 7 August convened by the Prime Minister's office and the chamber of commerce with private operators, the customs directorate [presented a project to interconnect customs information systems for goods in transit](#), aimed at cutting customs, transit and import-export processing times and building on a World Bank technical mission of 31 July. [Mali's implementation of the WTO Trade Facilitation Agreement was put at 83.6%](#) at the same consultation. No counterpart administration, timetable, cost or system name is stated.

Registries

A national digital directory of diaspora skills was launched at a ceremony in Washington on 22 August 2026, run by the Malian embassy to the United States and registering professional profiles across economic, administrative, academic, private-sector and emerging fields so that ministries can identify expertise against specific needs. The minister described it as an accreting database whose usefulness depends on take-up and on profiles being kept current; questions at the ceremony went to registration terms and to how the recorded data would be used, and no data-protection basis is stated.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

One commune is taking its own revenue problem in hand. Koutiala began digitising its fiscal census and financial management, surveying taxable commercial equipment and public-space use and equipping the town hall with financial-management tools, to widen its own-source revenue. It is funded by a foreign embassy and run with a non-governmental organisation, and no budget, timetable or revenue target is stated.

Rural digital data capture

The same week recommended an updated universal-access strategy with a white-zone map, against a 2030 universal connectivity target. No map, coverage baseline or funding line accompanies the recommendation.

Technology

AI

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique recommended a national AI strategy, which Mali does not have, alongside an AES protocol on AI governance. The Centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique closed the week with a demonstration of a locally built intrusion-detection technology.

Mali joined a regional framework rather than making one. Six francophone West African states adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines on 9 July, led by an advocacy organisation and announced at the Global Dialogue on AI Governance. The guidelines are non-binding and no Malian implementing instrument follows from them on the record.

Innovation ecosystem

A civil-society organisation launched an application for reporting and checking online content, alongside the closing report of a digital campaign against viral falsehood which it says reached 68,885 people. It is aimed at young people and civil-society organisations, and funded through a Danish foreign-ministry facility with support from the ministry responsible for communication and the digital economy. No user or report-volume figure is published.

Capacity

Training and skills

The same 22 July an operator reported 350 young people placed on the labour market from its digital centre.

On 30 July UNESCO and Japan handed the education ministry FCFA 88,740,927 of equipment for eight teacher-training institutes — 40 laptops, 16 all-in-one computers, 32 tablets, and projectors, whiteboards, printers and backup devices — with no maintenance, connectivity or software provision stated.

On 1 August recruitment opened for the first cohort of a [digital-skills programme for 15,000 young people](#) run under a convention with the Association Kabakoo.

Inclusion

Access to services

The month's one measure of what connectivity costs a Malian is a comparison with the neighbour. About [1.5GB of mobile data in Bamako buys what 25GB buys in Dakar](#) – a ratio of roughly 25 to 1, which critics attribute to weak market oversight by the regulator, the duopoly of the two incumbent operators, and the years since a new operator licence was issued. It is a press comparison rather than a regulator or operator tariff series, and neither the basket nor the date of the prices compared is stated; taken at its own weight it still sits awkwardly against the digital-sovereignty case the same month's fora were built around.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute runs a [microdata archive under its own domain holding 107 studies](#), led by the 2022 census and near-annual agricultural surveys since 1996/1997. It is a first-party statistical archive rather than a whole-of-government open-data portal, and the base holds nothing of the latter kind.

Use of satellite data

Work is under way to [finalise the creation by decree of an integrated national measurement, reporting and verification system](#) for the nationally determined contribution. No decree number, data source list or operator is on file.

Geopolitics

EU activities

There is [no dedicated European Union country programme for Mali for 2025 to 2027](#): the country is funded instead from the central-Sahel complex-settings allocation, with no digital or data-governance activity named in either tranche. No separate termination instrument for the previous programme has been found.

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